

KENDRIYA VIDYALAYA SANGATHAN REGIONAL OFFICE, HYDERABAD
PRE-BOARD -1 2024

CLASS X

ENGLISH COMMUNICATIVE – 101

TIME – 3 HOURS

MAX MARKS – 80

General Instruction:

15-minute prior reading time allotted for Question paper reading.

The Question Paper contains FOUR sections-

READING SKILLS, WRITING SKILLS, GRAMMAR and LITERATURE TEXTBOOK.

Attempt questions based on specific instructions for each part.

SECTION A: READING SKILLS (22 marks)

1. Read the passage given below: 12 Marks

1. Keep your watch accurate. For some people, moving up the time on their watch will help them get up earlier. For others, they will remember that the time on the watch is wrong and will disregard it altogether. Setting your watch just two minutes ahead instead of five or ten may be helpful.

2. Keep a clock, phone, computer or anything that displays time in each room of your house. One of the easiest ways to run late is simply by not realizing that the time is passing as quickly as it is.

3. Set all your clocks and watches at the same time. Don't be an optimist. Things usually take longer than you'd expect, even without major delays. If you have a dinner appointment at 7:30 p.m., don't think you can work till 7 p.m., then take a bath, dress and arrive on time. Realistically, calculate the time you will take at each step and then add 10 minutes more to allow for unexpected delays, or you cannot get to your job in time.

4. Wake up when you are supposed to wake up. Don't hit the snooze button, keep on lying in bed, and watching TV at the very start of your day. Maybe you can try even setting your clock 10 minutes earlier than you need. If you have difficulty with this, move your alarm clock to somewhere away from your bed; that way, you will have to get up to turn it off. Commit yourself to being 15 minutes early for everything. If you have to reach your place of work at 8:00, don't even tell yourself this. Just tell yourself (and everyone else who listens—but don't annoy them or make them think that they are late or early!) "I have to be at work at 7:45." If you do this, you will be on time even with little unforeseen delays. You will be on time even with a traffic jam.

Based on your understanding of the passage, answer the questions given below: (12 marks)

1. Fill in the blank by selecting the correct option.

We should be _____ in approach with time management. (1)

(a) optimistic

(c) realistic

(b) pessimistic

(d) utopian

2. Infer reasons for being delayed, based on information in paragraph 2: (2)

3. It is good to commit yourself _____ for everything. (1)

(a) to be late

(c) to being 15 minutes early

(b) to delay

(d) to search the last moment

4. What does the passage highlight? (2)

5. To be punctual we should _____. (2)

6. The narrator does not deny which of the following activities do not take time just after waking up: (1)

(a) hitting snooze button

(c) watch TV

(b) keep on lying in bed

(d) wake up when you have to

7. Based on your reading of the passage, examine, in about 40 words, how one can decipher that One of the easiest ways to run late is simply by not realizing that the time is passing as quickly as it is. (2)

8. Substitute the word 'unforeseen' with ONE WORD similar in meaning, in the following, sentence from paragraph 4: (1) Just tell yourself "I have to be at work at 7:45." If you do this, you will be on time even with little unforeseen delays (1)

2. Read the passage given below: 10 marks

1. I got posted in Srinagar in the 1980s. Its rugged mountains, gushing rivers and vast meadows reminded me of the landscapes of my native place – the Jibhi Valley in Himachal Pradesh. Unlike Srinagar that saw numerous tourists, Jibhi Valley remained clouded in anonymity. That's when the seed for starting tourism in Jibhi was planted. I decided to leave my service in the Indian Army and follow the urge to return home.
2. We had two houses – a family house and a traditional house, which we often rented out. I pleaded with my father to ask the tenant to vacate the house so that I could convert it into a guesthouse. When my family finally relented, I renovated the house keeping its originality intact, just adding windows for sunlight.
3. I still remember the summer of 1992 when I put a signboard outside my first guesthouse in Jibhi Valley! The village residents, however, were skeptical about my success. My business kept growing but it took years for tourism to take off in Jibhi Valley. Things changed significantly after 2008 when the government launched a homestay scheme. People built homestays and with rapid tourism growth, the region changed rapidly. Villages turned into towns with many concrete buildings. Local businesses and tourists continued putting a burden on nature.

4. Then, with the 2020-21 pandemic and lockdown, tourism came to a complete standstill in Jibhi Valley. Local people, who were employed at over a hundred homestays and guesthouses, returned to their villages. Some went back to farming; some took up pottery and some got involved in government work schemes. Now, all ardently hope that normalcy and tourism will return to the valley soon. In a way, the pandemic has allowed us to introspect, go to our roots, and look for sustainable solutions.
5. For me, tourism has been my greatest teacher. It brought people from many countries and all states of India to my guest house. It gave me exposure to different cultures and countless opportunities to learn new things. Most people who stayed at my guest house became my repeat clients and good friends. When I look back, I feel proud, yet humbled at the thought that I was not only able to fulfill my dream despite all the challenges but also play a role in establishing tourism in the beautiful valley that I call home. (394 words)

Answer the following questions, based on the passage above.

- (1) How does the setting contribute to the overall mood and atmosphere of the story in the passage? 1M
 - (a) The setting creates a sense of isolation and desolation, enhancing melancholic mood.
 - (b) The setting adds to the vibrancy and liveliness, contributing to an upbeat and cheerful atmosphere.
 - (c) The setting has no impact on the mood and atmosphere of the story.
 - (d) The setting evokes a sense of nostalgia, connecting the narrator's experiences with their native place.
- (2) State how the emotions felt by the author when renovating the traditional house for the guest house are analogous to the anticipation and excitement one might experience when transforming a cherished space into a fulfilling and purposeful endeavor. 2M
- (3) What is the main flaw in the actions of local businessmen concerning nature? 1M
 - (a) Excessive deforestation for commercial purposes.
 - (b) Unregulated construction and rapid development.
 - (c) Overreliance on government works chimes.
 - (d) Failure to adapt to sustainable agricultural practice
- (4) Substitute the underlined word in the following sentence with a word/ phrase from paragraph 5 that means the same. 1M

‘After joining the international conference, the young scientist had experience to cutting-edge research’.

- (5) What is the most significant lesson that the author learned during the pandemic? 1M
- (a) The importance of rapid tourism growth.
 - (b) The necessity of diversifying business options.
 - (c) The resilience of the local community.
 - (d) The effectiveness of government work schemes.
- (6) Complete the sentence appropriately. 2M
- From the statement, 'The village residents, however, were skeptical about my success 'one can infer that
- (7) Complete the sentence appropriately. 1M
- If the title, 'A Tale of Missed Opportunities 'would be given to the passage, it would be inappropriate, as compared to the title 'Establishing Tourism in Jibhi Valley 'because
- (8) State whether the given assertion is TRUE or FALSE. 1M
- The author plays a pivotal role in establishing tourism in the region despite, initial skepticism, and subsequent challenges.

SECTION B – WRITING 22M

- 3.** Write an email to the principal of your Vidyalaya requesting him to change your section and also give reasons for your request. 60 word (3 marks)
- 4.** You saw a bike advertisement and are greatly impressed by it. Write a paragraph in 100 words describing the bike: Colour, model, Engine capacity, milage, comfort ,brake etc (4 marks)
- 5.** India's growing population has been accompanied by massive urbanization. However, this rapid urbanization has been accompanied by an alarming rate of environmental degradation and a growing scarcity of natural resources. Write a letter to the editor of a national daily, drawing the attention of the public towards the development that is taking place at the cost of ecology and causing widespread environmental destruction and violation. Take clues from MCB Unit 4 'Environment'. You are Riya Khurana, living at C – 111, Phase I, Ashok Vihar New Delhi. (7 Marks) 120 words

Or

Write a letter to the Mayor of your city, addressing the issue of carelessness in transportation habits and advocating for initiatives to promote 'car-lessness' in the community. Deliberate on the environmental, health, and social benefits of reducing reliance on cars and propose specific measures to encourage alternative modes of transportation. Also, emphasize the importance of community engagement and collaboration in achieving a more sustainable and liveable city.

Use ideas from Unit 3: Science, along with your own to write this letter in not more than 120 words.

6: Compulsory value-based education is the only remedy for inculcating values among the future citizens of the country. This will also help in the prevention of crime in the country. Write an article on the need of compulsory value-based education, in about 150 words. Use the ideas that you may have gathered from MCB Unit 2 : Education and Unit 6 : National Integration. (8 marks)

OR

You are Dikshit, a sportsman, you are worried about the decreasing interest of students in sports and games. Write an article, in about 150 words, to be published in a magazine on the need for sports and games. You may use the hints given below along with your own ideas referring to the **MCB Unit 'Sports and Games'**. You are Akshay/ Akriti.

- Sitting most of the time
- Excessive use of internet
- Most don't walk to the school
- More importance to examination results

SECTION C – GRAMMAR 10M

7. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate option from those in the brackets.

1x3 =3 marks

- (i) _____ (Despite/but for/ instead) the rain, we had a great time.
(ii) _____ (Neither/Nor) of the options appealed to me.
(iii) The book is located _____ (on/at/in) the top shelf.

8. The following passage has not been edited. There is an error in each line against which a blank is given. Write the incorrect word and the correction in the space provided. 4m

		Incorrect	correct
i.	The team of researchers, led by Dr. Patel, have spent years studying the effects of		
ii.	climate change. The data they has collected shows a significant increase in global		
iii.	temperatures. The researchers is now working on a new project to develop sustainable		
iv.	solutions. The project, which will takes several years to complete, aims to reduce carbon emissions."		

9. Read the dialogue given below. Based on your reading, fill the gaps with appropriate words or phrases. Do not add any new information. 1x3 = 3 marks

Patient: I want to consult the doctor.

Receptionist: He is busy. You can come tomorrow morning.

Patient: Then it will be my ghost coming tomorrow.

Receptionist: Then you can see an exorcist here.

The patient told the receptionist (I) _____.

The receptionist replied that the doctor was busy and that he (II)_____.

The patient tried to frighten her by saying that (III)_____, the receptionist calmly stated that then he could see the exorcist there.

SECTION – D LITERATURE 26M

10. Read the extract given below and answer any two (2) : 4+4=8m

(A) He reached down from a fissure in the earth-wall in the gloom
And trailed his yellow-brown slackness soft-bellied down, over
the edge of the stone trough
And rested his throat upon the stone bottom,
And where the water had dripped from the tap, in a small clearness,

- i. Who is 'he' here?
- ii. What Symbolism might be associated with the snake's emergence from darkness?
- iii. Analyze the use of the color "yellow-brown" in the passage.
- iv. Imagine the scene before the snake's emergence. Describe it.

OR

(b) Look on my Works, ye Mighty, and despair!
Nothing beside remains. Round the decay
Of that colossal Wreck, boundless and bare
The lone and level sands stretch far away."

- i. Who is the speaker addressing?
- ii. What is the significance of the inscription "My name is Ozymandias, king of kings"?
- iii. Identify examples of irony.
- iv. How does the poem comment on the fleeting nature of human achievement?

C) You know not what you do: do not
consent That Antony speak in his
funeral:

Know you how much the people may be moved

By that which he will utter! (Julius Caesar)

- i. Identify the speaker of the given lines. (1M)
- ii. Whose 'funeral' is being talked about? (1M)
- iii. Why did the speaker raise this objection? (1M)
- iv. Give the antonym of word 'consent'. (1M)

11. Answer any five questions in 30-40 words. 5x2=10m

- a) What arrangements were made by the villagers to make a tiger available to Mrs. Packletide and thus earn a thousand rupees?
- b) Describe the early morning scene when Ali visited the post office.
- c) Why did Lavinia feel that the Ouija would help her husband?
- d) What were the special touches, Patol Babu gave to his role to make it more authentic?
- e) There have been several incidents in the poem where the readers can see the frog being jealous of the nightingale. Elaborate.
- f) How does the poet in 'Ozymandias' highlight the enduring nature of art and language compared to other symbols of power? .

12. Attempt any one of the following questions in about 150 words. 8 marks

A) One feels another's pain only when one goes through it himself/herself. Explain the postmaster's change of heart in the chapter The Letter and why it takes place. (150 Words)

OR

B) In the poem, the nightingale's uniqueness and individuality are threatened by the frog's insistence on conformity. What values can we derive from the nightingale's struggles, and how can we apply them to our own lives? (150 Words)